of agricultural land and life under communism. The play was performed in Archita, Malancrav, Richis, Sighisoara and Viscri.
In a further workshop in Viscri, the children learnt how to use a computer, to store pictures, to conduct interviews and to create a blog of their project: http://edu-act.blogspot.com.
Under Mr. Schaas from Richis, they were taught the history of citadels, the Saxon villages and the ancient way of life. They also saw traditional crafts being made and produced their own bricks at the kiln in Viscri.
The Trust has been running the education project with the aim of protecting local history. It is financed by the Romanian Cultural Fund in partnership with the Sighisoara J.Haltrich high school.

DECEMBER

WHOLE VILLAGE PROJECT:

Fundamental to the Trust's aim of regeneration is The Whole Village Project. To conclude the year, therefore, we present a short summary of work completed during 2012 in six villages. In **Alma Vii** we finished the facade and installed a new bathroom and a septic tank in house No 104. In the doctor's centre, we completed the plasterwork of the interior and installed a new bathroom, new doors and a new stove. In **Archita** House No 302 was fully restored and plans were prepared for work next year in house No 152. In **Crit** we completed work on the facades of Houses No 14, 82, 53 and 57 and made major improvement to the appearance of Houses No 113 and 160, the barn behind No 185 and the main wall of House No 109.
In **Malancrav** two new barns were erected at Houses No 297 and 335, and the facade of House No 413 at the village entrance was completely restored. The property also now has a new oak fence. A long high stone wall flanking the orchard on the way to the Apafi Manor was built and a new lightning conductor was installed.
The strong community spirit of **Richis** meant that we could complete in record time the restoration of the vast community hall in the heart of the village. Local builders and volunteer workers achieved this together. In **Viscri** we finished a full restoration of House No 39, the facade of No 32, interior works at No 83 and major roof repairs and facade work at number 84. In the village itself, which has become a magnet for some 12,000 visitors a year, new infrastructure began with a public toilet and attractive signs marking the Entrance and Exit to the village.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

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OTHER INFORMATION

The achievements of the Trust are only made possible by your donations. Please send any offering to either of our offices. Over its first 12 years the MET benefited from the remarkable generosity of the Packard Humanities Institute. Their programme of giving came to a conclusion two years ago so, in order to continue with our restoration projects we must look elsewhere for our fund raising, which makes every grant or donation all the more valuable.

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The Mihai Eminescu Trust

NEWSLETTER 2012

FIRE ENGINE CEREMONY IN SIGHISOARA



Three fire engines and a support truck, given to the MET by Shropshire Fire Service Volunteers, were presented to the Mures and Brasov County fire services. The English volunteers raised the funds to buy the vehicles and gave up spare time and holidays to drive them from Shropshire to Transylvania. The fire engines will provide invaluable fire protection for the area covered by the Trust. The handover ceremony in the Citadel's central square was attended by Martin Harris the British Ambassador and the Romanian Under-Secretary of State for Health Raed Arafat. The project's successful outcome owes much to Shropshire's Head of Conservation, Colin Richards and Shropshire Assistant Chief Fire Officer, Dr Steve Worrall, without whom this exceptionally generous donation could never have happened. The following day, the fire service also equipped homes with smoke detectors and villages with fire pumps as part of a wider strategy for improving fire safety.

JANUARY

STREET SIGNS REPLACED IN MEDIAEVAL CITADEL

To preserve the historic identity in the squares and streets of Sighisoara's Citadel, the MET replaced the existing signs with elegant new ones made by local craftsmen supported by the Citadel Residents' Group. Engraved in old gothic, these signs display the current and historic names of each street and were fixed by a group of French and Romanian volunteers.

FEBRUARY

CHURCHES IN TRANSYLVANIA



Archita Church

One of the most important parts of the Trust's work has always been protecting and restoring Transylvania's religious buildings of many denominations - Orthodox, Catholic, Lutheran and Jewish. We are still trying to raise money for the **Medias** synagogue. Meanwhile, work on two Lutheran churches continues. Having joined the EU Leistelle programme in an advisory capacity for the restoration of **Archita** church and its interior, we have now stepped in with the help of the Horizon Foundation to save and restore its exterior towers and magnificent fortification. This is the start of a three year programme.
Our other duty has been to save the beautiful church in **Alma Vii** - not included in the EU programme. While we await the outcome of our grant application to restore the church and its precincts, Colin Richards brought his team from Shropshire and, with the help of Alma Vii villagers, carried out emergency interventions to the main defense wall to prevent further damage and the imminent risk of collapse.

MARCH

CAPACITY BUILDING PROJECT FOR MET

The first phase of this important project, supported by the Horizon Foundation, was completed in 2011. It has created an inventory of 1041 completed MET projects, enabling the Trust to plan future development and strategy, based on the conservation skills and expertise acquired.
Seminars were organised in Sighisoara and Sibiu with national and international experts participating. In 2013 similar ones are planned for Brasov, Cluj-Napoca and Bucharest.

APRIL

A FOREST FOR EVERY SCHOOL

With the generous support of Accor's *Plant for the Planet* project, the Trust celebrated the planting of 500,000 native species saplings in areas affected by pollution, deforestation and landslides in Brasov, Sibiu and Mures counties. In Sighisoara, we presented the tree nursery with 40.000 new saplings. The Trust's aim is to have planted over 1,000,000 trees by the end of the project.

MAY

HRH THE DUKE OF KENT VISIT TO MET IN TRANSYLVANIA



HRH The Duke of Kent with Jessica Douglas-Home in Viscri

Prince Edward made a private visit to Transylvania, accompanied by his son The Earl of St Andrews. They stayed at the Apafi Manor as guests of Jessica Douglas-Home, and from here walked in the hills surrounding Malancrav taking the opportunity to see the Trust's work. They also visited Alma Vii, Viscri, Crit, Sighisoara. In Sibiu he visited Mayor Johannes Klaus, followed by a delicious lunch in the traditional Romanian village of Sibiel.

JUNE

PRIZE FOR WASTE WATER PURIFICATION SYSTEM IN VISCRI

At the Civil Society Gala in Bucharest the MET was honoured with a prize within the EEA Heritage Project *"Conservation of the Historic Landscape in the Saxon villages of Transylvania"*, followed by First Prize for *"Social and Economic Development"* and the Sustainability Prize for its ecological water purification system in Viscri. This pioneering installation, predominantly financed by the Trust's Patron, HRH the Prince of Wales, forms part of the MET's rural development program. The Romanian Prime Minister congratulated the MET on the remarkable project.

JULY

HISTORIC CITADEL GATEWAY REPAIRED

The MET completed the restoration of the Furriers Tower in the Sighisoara Citadel with the generous help of British and Romanian volunteers coordinated by Colin Richards.
The tower displays a permanent exhibition of the Trust's work including examples of traditional Saxon building techniques. On the first floor, a local craftsman holds a small workshop where he makes leather goods.
Repair and re-rendering of both sides of a section of the citadel wall was completed by volunteers from Malancrav, Richis and Porumbacu de Sus as well as by Colin Richards' team from Shropshire.
The Torle gateway, adjacent to the MET's Sighisoara office, was also restored under Colin Richards' supervision, again with the help of British and Romanian volunteer builders.



The Torle gateway

AUGUST

Many disparate but appreciative visitors came to stay in our houses during the summer.
Taking a break from the large film festival in Medias, **Radu Gabrea** went for rest and recreation to the Apafi Manor. Over lunch he and a group of actresses, actors and writers discussed life with MET's director Caroline Fernolend.
The historian **Hugh Thomas** stayed at the Apafi manor, in order to visit the area and understand the landscape of forests, fertile lands and castles in preparation for writing the preface for Miklós Bánffy's trilogy 'A Transylvanian Tale'.
"I congratulate you very warmly – 'hertzlich'", he wrote. "The achievement of the Mihai Eminescu Trust is really remarkable. You have not just financed a philanthropic enterprise, you have founded a new/old society of beauty and antiquity".



Hugh Thomas



Dominic West

The British actor **Dominic West**, famous for his role as Officer Jimmy McNulty in the US television series The Wire, came for the week-end, but could not be dragged away and sent a message to Andrea Rost:
"Andrea - what a wonderful place! The House and my guest house lady, Nicoletta are lovely and dinner utterly delicious. I'm trying to extend my stay perhaps by many days - maybe till next Thursday. Is there a house available till then? I'd love to see the other houses too. I'm in such heaven - thank you! I have recommended the MET website to several friends; I think the Trust's work is so important".
After Prince Nicholas von Preussen, the Kaiser's great grandson, discovered Saxon Transylvania, he too could hardly bear to leave, returning many times during the year. He particularly enjoyed talking in German with Herr Schaas and being shown the historic details of the 14th Century Richis Church.

SEPTEMBER

Marius Panait and Nelu Molnar, who trained in the first Viscri stone masonry workshops 12 years ago, were invited by Ludlow Civic Society to help British colleagues restore an ancient wall in Ludlow beside the St Laurence Church. On a tour of the town, HRH The Prince of Wales met the two master builders and discussed their work on site and back in Viscri.

OCTOBER

The visit of the Shropshire team in October has produced an enduring legacy. The project to convert the Trust's brick kiln in Viscri to also make lime was a great success. The kiln master, Gheorghe Lascu, can now produce three tons of lime per week which he will continue to do throughout the winter months, in preparation for the Trust's 2013 building programme.The use of traditional lime mortars underpins much of the Trust's work in conserving the ancient building fabric of the Saxon Villages.
This age old material is breathable and flexible, accommodating the climatic changes and structural movement in ancient buildings, and creates a greater durability which harder cement mortars cannot achieve. However in recent times the supply of lime in Romania has diminished and what limited sources exist have become prohibitively expensive. The Trust can now supply its own needs with this valuable mortar. The kiln building work was undertaken by Mick Krupa Joe Richards and John Harrison.

NOVEMBER

MET THEATRE PROJECT

A group of 17 boys and girls from the villages Archita, Malancrav and Sighisoara collected local historical facts throughout the summer. The results were followed up by 2 workshops in Biertan. Under the guidance of a specialist in applied theatre, Ulrike Lück, and Andrea Rost from MET, the group developed a play in mime and gesture to describe the time under Prince Michael Apafi in Malancrav, the deportation of Saxons to Russia, the collectivisation